

EPISODIC PIVOT PLAYBOOK

Daily execution checklist — Qullamaggie-style EP workflow. The screener finds gappers; this checklist finds the trade. Most days the right answer is zero trades.

1 | EVENING PREP

Prior evening / weekend · 20-30 min

- ☐ Run **Breakout Leaders** scans (1M > 25% / 3M > 50% / 6M > 100%), sorted by performance
Eyeball for tightening flags riding the 10/20-day SMA with drying volume. No filter finds a clean flag — your eyes do.
- ☐ Add flag setups to **BO Watch** list; set a price alert at each pivot high
Breakout entries are pre-planned the night before. Never hunted live.
- ☐ Note tomorrow's earnings calendar and any pending catalysts on watch names

2 | PRE-MARKET TRIAGE

8:00 - 9:15 AM ET

- ☐ Check market context first: QQQ / SPY futures, key levels
Hostile tape = half size, higher standards, or no trades. Sitting out is a position.
- ☐ Run **EP Pre-market** screen. Sort by pre-market change %
- ☐ **GATE 1 — CATALYST:** open the news on every candidate
PASS: earnings blowout + raised guidance, FDA approval, major contract, transformative news. CUT: vague PR, offering, sympathy gap, analyst note.
- ☐ **GATE 2 — CHART:** pull the daily
PASS: months of sideways/down neglect, gapping into open air or new highs. CUT: already up 100%+ recently, or gapping into heavy overhead supply.
- ☐ **GATE 3 — SIZE:** project the volume
Pre-market volume should project to the **biggest volume day in 1+ year**. Quick check: pre-mkt vol vs. 30-day average — multiples, not fractions.
- ☐ Survivors (target 2-6 names) → ranked watchlist, best first

3 | STAGING

9:15 - 9:29 AM ET

- ☐ Load survivors into multi-chart layout: **Daily + 5-min + 1-min**, watchlist synced
- ☐ Set alerts at each candidate's pre-market high
- ☐ Calculate share size for each name **before the bell** (formula, page 2); pre-stage order tickets
Fast EPs give you seconds. Execution is pre-planned, never improvised.

4 | ENTRY — OPENING RANGE BREAKOUT

9:30 AM ET +

Stock speed	Trigger	Stop
Fast, liquid mover	Break of 1-min opening range high	Opening range low / LOD
Standard EP	Break of 5-min opening range high	Opening range low / LOD
Slower large-cap gap	Break of 15/60-min opening range high	Opening range low / LOD

- ☐ Buy the break of the opening range high **only** — never the open itself
You are buying proof of demand after the open, not hope at the bell.
- ☐ Volume confirms on the break; stock holds above VWAP
- ☐ No trigger, or immediate fade below VWAP → **no trade, next name**

SIZING, MANAGEMENT & REVIEW

5 | POSITION SIZING

Decided before entry, always

$$\text{Shares} = (\text{Account} \times \text{Risk } \%) \div (\text{Entry} - \text{Stop})$$

- ☐ Risk per trade: **0.25-0.5%** of account (max ~1% once proven). Size from the stop distance — never from conviction
Tight EP stops mean positions often reach 10-20% of account. The formula makes that survivable at a ~40-45% win rate.

6 | TRADE MANAGEMENT

Days 1 → weeks

- ☐ Day 1: stop stays at opening range low / low of day. No averaging down, ever
- ☐ Day 3-5: sell **1/3 to 1/2 into strength**; move stop on remainder to breakeven
- ☐ Trail the rest: **10-day SMA** (fast movers) or **20-day SMA** (slower), closing basis
This is how a one-day gap becomes a multi-week or multi-month winner. Let the MA take you out.
- ☐ Gap holds and builds above VWAP = right; loses the gap = wrong. Act accordingly

7 | DO-NOT-TRADE LIST

Any one = automatic pass

- ☐ No real catalyst (vague PR, sympathy move, offering, promo)
- ☐ Stock already extended — up 100%+ in recent months before the gap
- ☐ Gapping into heavy overhead resistance
- ☐ Volume does not project to a 1-year+ record day
- ☐ Sub-\$2 price, nano-cap, tiny float halt-machine, or spread you can't exit
- ☐ Chasing an extended move past the opening range, or hostile tape with no reduced-size plan

8 | JOURNAL & REVIEW

Daily 5 min · Monthly 1 hr

- ☐ Screenshot every trade at entry and exit; log setup grade, gates passed, mistake tags
- ☐ Monthly: review all trades — count the avoidable mistakes
His own monthly reviews find that cutting a few dumb mistakes would roughly double results.
- ☐ Skill reps: study 50+ historical EPs in bar replay before sizing up

"The goal is not to trade often, but to trade well."

Personal process document — not financial advice. Win rate on this setup is ~40-45%; the edge lives in sizing, stops, and selectivity.